SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

21 October 2024 · Shift 1

73 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 17 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 12 questions

Q.1

Akhil bought two articles at ₹4,500 each. He sold one article at a 12% gain but had to sell the second article at a loss. If he had suffered a loss of ₹395 on the whole transaction, then what was the selling price of the second article?

(A) ₹3,595
(B) ₹3,550
(C) ₹3,565
(D) ₹3,500

Q.4

There are two groups C and D of a class consisting of 32 and 40 students, respectively. If the average weight of group C is 60 kg and that of group D is 33 kg, then find the average weight of the whole class.

(A) 45.2 kg
(B) 45 kg
(C) 44 kg
(D) 46.5 kg

Q.5

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 5% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 565
(B) 625
(C) 585
(D) 665

Q.9

A vessel contains 80 litres of a mixture of alcohol and water in the ratio of 3 : 7. If 40 litres of the mixture is taken out from the vessel and replaced with 40 litres of water, then the ratio of alcohol and water becomes:

(A) 3 : 23
(B) 2 : 15
(C) 3 : 17
(D) 1 : 11

Q.10

A boat can travel at a speed of 42 km/hr in still water. If the speed of the stream is 3 km/hr, how much time (in hours and minutes) will be taken by the boat to go 157.5 km downstream, and then 78 km upstream?

(A) 6 h 20 min
(B) 7 h 25 min
(C) 4 h 45 min
(D) 5 h 30 min

Q.11

If apples and pears in a basket are in the ratio of 5 : 8, then find the percentage of pears (correct to two decimal places) in the basket.

(A) 63.45%
(B) 61.54%
(C) 59.44%
(D) 69.5%

Q.13

b is the sum of two quantities, one of which varies inversely as the square of a^2 , and the other of which varies directly as a. Identify the relationship between a and b if b = 49 when a = 3 or 5.

(A) $b = 8a + 225/a^2$

(B) $a = 3b^2 - 7/a$

(C) $b = 2a$

(D) $a = 3b$

Q.14

The average weight of two persons A and B is 70 kg. Another person C joins A and B and the average weight now becomes 72 kg. If another person D, whose weight is 2 kg less than that of C, replaces A, then the average weight of B, C and D becomes 70 kg. Find the weight of A (in kg).

(A) 74

(B) 75

(C) 80

(D) 73

Q.17

A man bought an article for ₹500 and sold it for ₹400. Find his loss percentage.

(A) 30%

(B) 100%

(C) 25%

(D) 20%

Q.18

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 65 kg and 39 kg is:

(A) 49.8

(B) 48.8

(C) 51.8

(D) 50.8

Q.19

Two numbers are in the ratio of 7:9 and their LCM is 630. Find the numbers

(A) 56, 72

(B) 63, 81

(C) 77, 99

(D) 70, 90

Q.20

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 4% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 520

(B) 500

(C) 560

(D) 600

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'COST' is coded as '5971' and 'SALE' is coded as '8692'. What is the code for 'S' in that language?

(A) 9

(B) 6

(C) 8

(D) 7

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusion(s) logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: Some mats are carpets. All carpets are sheets. Conclusions: (I) Some mats are sheets. (II) All sheets are carpets.

(A) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow.

(B) Only conclusion (I) follows.

(C) Only conclusion (II) follows.

(D) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows.

Q.3

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (5, 14, 24) (9, 6, 24)

(A) (11, 12, 34)
(B) (15, 19, 89)
(C) (17, 10, 42)
(D) (21, 23, 55)

Q.4

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts,decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All eggs are chickens. No chicken is a hen. Conclusions: (I) All chickens are eggs. (II) No egg is a hen.

(A) Only conclusion II follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.5

CTVU is related to EVXW in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, BKGI is related to DMIK. To which of the following is SAEH related, following the same logic?

(A) MPEF
(B) HYTF
(C) UCGJ
(D) LOJI

Q.6

Seven friends - P, Q, R, A, X, Y, and Z - are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Y is sitting sixth to the right of Q. P is sitting third to the left of Y. A has Q and X as immediate neighbours. Z is to the immediate right of P. Who is sitting to the immediate right of R?

(A) P
(B) Q
(C) Y
(D) X

Q.7

In a certain code language, ‘life is rude’ is written as ‘tp ck gn’ and ‘this isn’t life’ is written as ‘gn dl sb’. How is ‘life’ written in that code language?

(A) dl
(B) tp
(C) ck
(D) gn

Q.10

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? AZB, BYC, CXD, DWE ,?

(A) EVF
(B) GUH
(C) EFU
(D) FVE

Q.11

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only 2 people sit between B and D when counted from the left of D. E and C are immediate neighbours of A. G sits immediately to the right of F. Only 1 person sits between F and E when counted from the right of E. Who sits immediately to the left of F?

(A) G
(B) A
(C) D
(D) B

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'HOST' is coded as '2846' and 'TEAM' is coded as '3587'. What is the code for 'T' in the given code language?

(A) 8
(B) 3
(C) 6
(D) 7

Q.13

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 25 – 45 × 9 ÷ 5 + 20 = ?

(A) 33
(B) 32
(C) 30
(D) 35

Q.15

5 is related to 77 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 9 is related to 137. To which of the following is 3 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 49
(B) 47
(C) 44
(D) 45

Q.16

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 7 ? 22 37 57 82

(A) 17
(B) 12
(C) 10
(D) 20

Q.17

VDIZ is related to ZGKA in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, HNAS is related to LQCT. To which of the following is BJWP related, following the same logic?

(A) DKXR
(B) FMYQ
(C) ENAS
(D) DLZR

Q.18

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 121 + 1 – 6 ÷ 16 × 8 = ?

(A) 164
(B) 124
(C) 132
(D) 145

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In which of the following cases did the Supreme Court of India propound the Basic Structure Doctrine of the Constitution?

(A) Kesavanad Bharati vs. State of Kerala Case
(B) Indira Gandhi vs. Raj Narayan Case
(C) Golakhnath vs. State of Punjab Case
(D) Maneka Gandhi vs Union of India Case

Q.2

According to the Multidimensional Poverty Index 2023, which union territory has the least percentage of poor?

(A) Lakshadweep
(B) Puducherry
(C) Delhi
(D) Chandigarh

Q.3

In 1527, Babur defeated Rana Sanga, the Rajput ruler of Mewar in the Battle of _____.

(A) Chanderi
(B) Panipat
(C) Tarain
(D) Khanwa

Q.4

Pushyamitra Sunga's capital was at:

(A) Nalanda
(B) Cuttack
(C) Kalinga
(D) Pataliputra

Q.5

Who among the following was awarded the Sansad Ratna Award 2023 and represents the Indian National Congress in Lok Sabha from West Bengal?

(A) Bidyut Baran Mahato
(B) Kuldeep Rai Sharma
(C) Sudhir Gupta
(D) Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury

Q.6

Identify the Kuchipudi dancer, actor and film producer who won the best choreography award at the 68th National Film Awards 2022.

(A) Sandhya Raju
(B) Ganesh Acharya
(C) Remo D'Souza
(D) Birju Maharaj

Q.7

Fugdi is famous dance of the state of _____.

(A) Goa
(B) Punjab
(C) Uttarakhand
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.8

Tanras Khan is associated with which of the following gharanas?

(A) Benaras gharana
(B) Agra gharana
(C) Indore gharana
(D) Delhi gharana

Q.9

The North-South National Highway Corridor connects which two UTs/States of India?

(A) Jammu and Kashmir - Tamil Nadu
(B) Ladakh - Kerala
(C) Delhi - Odisha
(D) Jammu and Kashmir - Telangana

Q.10

What is the primary role of autotrophic organisms in an ecosystem?

(A) Producing organic matter from inorganic substances
(B) Converting organic matter into energy
(C) Preying on other organisms for food
(D) Breaking down dead organisms

Q.11

Which of the following water bodies are also known as nurseries of the ocean?

(A) Bogs
(B) Dams
(C) Lagoons
(D) Estuaries

Q.12
What is the term for a dome-shaped monument that contains sacred relics in Buddhism?

(A) Chaitya
(B) Vihar
(C) Stambha
(D) Stupa

Q.13
Who wrote the novel ‘Amrit Aur Vish’?

(A) Vishnu Prabhakar
(B) Ramdhari Singh Dinkar
(C) Amritlal Nagar
(D) Shreelal Shukla

Q.14
According to the standard definition of Census of India, the marginal worker is a person who works for less than _____ days in a year.

(A) 180
(B) 173
(C) 170
(D) 183

Q.15
The ‘Agaria’ community of the 19th century was associated with which of the following industries?

(A) Cotton textile industry
(B) Agro Industry
(C) Wood industry
(D) Iron industry

Q.16
Who inaugurated 'Vibrant Village Program' in april 2023?

(A) Ashwini Vaishnav
(B) Hardeep Puri
(C) Narendra Modi
(D) Amit Shah

Q.17
Why are wealth taxes and gift taxes treated as paper taxes in India?

(A) Tax payers need to fill out forms only in paper and submit returns.
(B) They do not generate much revenue in comparison to others.
(C) They are paid only by government employees, members of the Parliament and Legislative assemblies.
(D) It is not mandatory for the government to collect these taxes.

Q.18
Where is the Kala Ghoda Arts Festival organised every year?

(A) Mumbai
(B) New Delhi
(C) Bengaluru
(D) Chennai

Q.19
What is the charge of an electron?

(A) Positive
(B) Neutral
(C) Variable
(D) Negative

Q.20
The ‘Dhansiri’ and ‘Subansiri’ are the tributaries of _____ River.

(A) Godavari
(B) Sutlej
(C) Brahmaputra
(D) Mahanadi

Q.21
The Border-Gavaskar trophy is played between _____.

(A) India and Pakistan
(B) India and England
(C) India and New Zealand
(D) India and Australia

Q.22

Which of the following reports is considered as a piecemeal effort to provide resilience to the successful working of federal system?

(A) Sarkaria Commission
(B) Kothari Commission
(C) Thakkar Commission
(D) Kapur Commission

Q.23

The Banaras session of the Indian National Congress in 1905 was presided over by _____.

(A) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(B) Subhas Chandra Bose
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q.24

Excessive bleeding from wounds may happen due to lack of ____.

(A) Vitamin B12
(B) Vitamin A
(C) Vitamin E
(D) Vitamin K

Q.25

Anahat Singh is associated with which of the following sports events?

(A) Squash
(B) Wrestling
(C) Chess
(D) Badminton

English Language and Comprehension 21 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Siva is a hard worker. He works _____.

(A) hard
(B) hardly
(C) bad
(D) scarcely

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. You can do your work well within the stipulated time and be more productive if you learn to keep video games “at the length of your arm.”

(A) at arm of his length
(B) at arm's weight
(C) at arm of your length
(D) at arm’s length

Q.3

Select the most appropriate idiom to substitute the underlined word segment in the given sentence. If the two families could “forget their past quarrels” forever, both could benefit immensely.

(A) bury the hatchet
(B) cut to the quick
(C) catch a tartar
(D) do a good turn

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) paralel
(B) familiar
(C) humorous
(D) achieve

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution’. There have been “numerous” attempts made by the citizens to restore parity.

(A) No substitution
(B) Quite numerous
(C) More numerous
(D) Most numerous

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. I could _____ the reason for being _____.

(A) barred; bard
(B) bard; barred
(C) find; fined
(D) fine; find

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who brings a legal action against someone in court.

(A) Pragmatist
(B) Plaintiff
(C) Numismatic
(D) Sanctimonious

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined phrase. In the “absence of government rule”, riots have broken out all over the country and everything is in a state of complete chaos.

(A) Anarchy
(B) Dictatorship
(C) Oligarchy
(D) Monarchy

Q.10

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Siliguri “has joined the nation to celebrate” the golden jubilee of the first conquest of Mount Everest by an Indian.

(A) No improvement required
(B) joined the national celebration
(C) joining the nation celebrate
(D) joins the celebratory nation

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Presumably

(A) Certainly
(B) Successfully
(C) Unlikely
(D) Liberally

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The detail given by the instructor was the _____ one.

(A) more updation
(B) updates
(C) most updated
(D) updating

Q.15

Select the word that has the same meaning (SYNONYM) as the underlined word in the given sentence. The prisoners were living in “appalling” conditions.

(A) risky
(B) daring
(C) shocking
(D) ingenuous

Q.16

Select the most appropriate homophone to fill in the blank. Looking up, she realised she had swum _____ than she’d thought.

(A) farthest
(B) furthest
(C) farther
(D) further

Q.18

Select the grammatically correct sentence.

(A) The myriad of possibilities unfolds when an artist embarks on the journey of creative experimentation.
(B) A myriad of possibilities unfolds when the artist embarks on the journey of creative experimentation.
(C) A myriad of possibilities unfolds when an artist embarks on a journey of creative experimentation.
(D) The myriad of possibilities unfolds when the artist embarks on a journey of creative experimentation.

Q.19

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. He sings good / among all the / contestants in / the singing competition.

(A) contestants in
(B) He sings good
(C) the singing competition
(D) among all the

Q.20

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The recommendations of the committee / regarding changes in the eligibility criteria / was not accept.

(A) was not accept
(B) The recommendations of the committee
(C) No Error
(D) regarding changes in the eligibility criteria

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The habit of reading is highly advantageous to us intellectually, emotionally and spiritually. As one gets into the habit of reading, one gets mental (1)_____. It helps us acquire (2)_____and attain intellectual (3)_____. Reading takes away our (4)_____. Reading can bring (5)_____ in our sorrowful times and guide us in our duties.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) exhaustion
(B) success
(C) coverage
(D) satisfaction

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The habit of reading is highly advantageous to us intellectually, emotionally and spiritually. As one gets into the habit of reading, one gets mental (1)_____. It helps us acquire (2)_____and attain intellectual (3)_____. Reading takes away our (4)_____. Reading can bring (5)_____ in our sorrowful times and guide us in our duties.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) employment
(B) knowledge
(C) readiness
(D) strategies

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The habit of reading is highly advantageous to us intellectually, emotionally and spiritually. As one gets into the habit of reading, one gets mental (1)_____. It helps us acquire (2)_____and attain intellectual (3)_____. Reading takes away our (4)_____. Reading can bring (5)_____ in our sorrowful times and guide us in our duties.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) compression
(B) expansion
(C) creation
(D) stagnation

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The habit of reading is highly advantageous to us intellectually, emotionally and spiritually. As one gets into the habit of reading, one gets mental (1)_____. It helps us acquire (2)_____and attain intellectual (3)_____. Reading takes away our (4)_____. Reading can bring (5)_____ in our sorrowful times and guide us in our duties.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) time
(B) concern
(C) boredom
(D) vigour

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The habit of reading is highly advantageous to us intellectually, emotionally and spiritually. As one gets into the habit of reading, one gets mental (1)_____. It helps us acquire (2)_____and attain intellectual (3)_____. Reading takes away our (4)_____. Reading can bring (5)_____ in our sorrowful times and guide us in our duties.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) comfort
(B) lethargy
(C) resentment
(D) oppression

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**
Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**			

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (C) ₹3,565

The two articles cost ₹9,000, so with a loss of ₹395 they sold for ₹8,605. The first sold for 4,500 × 1.12 = ₹5,040, so the second for 8,605 − 5,040 = ₹3,565.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 45 kg

(32 × 60 + 40 × 33)/72 = (1,920 + 1,320)/72 = 3,240/72 = 45 kg.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 625

SI = 2500 × 5 × 5/100 = ₹625.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 3 : 17

The 80 litres hold 24 litres of alcohol and 56 of water. Taking out half leaves 12 and 28; adding 40 litres of water makes 12 : 68 = 3 : 17.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 5 h 30 min

Downstream at 42 + 3 = 45 km/h, 157.5/45 = 3.5 hours; upstream at 42 − 3 = 39 km/h, 78/39 = 2 hours. Total 5.5 hours: 5 h 30 min.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 61.54%

Pears are 8 parts out of 5 + 8 = 13: 8/13 × 100 = 61.54%.

Q.13 · Answer (A) $b = 8a + 225/a^2$

Take $b = k/a^2 + ma$ (the printed 'square of a^2' means a^2). b = 49 at a = 3 and at a = 5 gives k + 27m = 441 and k + 125m = 1,225, so 98m = 784, m = 8 and k = 225: $b = 8a + 225/a^2$.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 80

A + B = 140 and A + B + C = 3 × 72 = 216, so C = 76 and D = 74. B + C + D = 3 × 70 = 210 gives B = 60, so A = 140 − 60 = 80.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 20%

Loss = ₹100 on a cost of ₹500: 100/500 × 100 = 20%.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 49.8

(40 + 49 + 56 + 65 + 39)/5 = 249/5 = 49.8 kg.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 70, 90

The numbers are 7k and 9k, whose LCM is 63k = 630, so k = 10: 70 and 90.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 560

SI = 3500 × 4 × 4/100 = ₹560.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (A) 9

S is the only letter in both words and 9 the only digit in both codes, so S = 9.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Only conclusion (I) follows.

The mats that are carpets are sheets, so some mats are sheets (I). All carpets being sheets does not make all sheets carpets, so II does not follow.

Q.3 · Answer (A) (11, 12, 34)

Twice the first number plus the second gives the third: 2 × 5 + 14 = 24 and 2 × 9 + 6 = 24. Likewise 2 × 11 + 12 = 34.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows

Every egg is a chicken and no chicken is a hen, so no egg is a hen (II). All eggs being chickens does not make all chickens eggs, so I does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (C) UCGJ
Each letter moves 2 places forward: CTVU → EVXW and BKGI → DMIK. So SAEH → UCGJ.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Y
With seven seats, sixth to Q's right is Q's immediate left, so Y sits there. Clockwise round the table: Q, Y, R, Z, P, X, A (facing the centre, each person's left is the next seat clockwise): P is third to Y's left, Z on P's right, A between Q and X, and R in the last seat. Y is on R's immediate right.

Q.7 · Answer (D) gn
'life' is the only word in both sentences and 'gn' the only code in both, so life = gn.

Q.10 · Answer (A) EVF
The first letters run A, B, C, D, E; the middle letters Z, Y, X, W, V; the last letters B, C, D, E, F. The next term is EVF.

Q.11 · Answer (D) B
Clockwise round the table: D, G, F, B, E, A, C (facing the centre, each person's left is the next seat clockwise). Counting left from D, G and F come before B; F is two seats to E's right with G on F's right, and A sits between E and C. B is on F's immediate left.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 8
T is the only letter in both words and 8 the only digit in both codes, so T = 8.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 30
After interchanging the signs: 25 + 45 ÷ 9 × 5 – 20 = 25 + 25 – 20 = 30.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 47
The second number is 15 times the first plus 2: 15 × 5 + 2 = 77 and 15 × 9 + 2 = 137. Likewise 15 × 3 + 2 = 47.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 12
The differences grow by 5: 7 + 5 = 12, 12 + 10 = 22, 22 + 15 = 37, 37 + 20 = 57 and 57 + 25 = 82.

Q.17 · Answer (B) FMYQ
The letters move +4, +3, +2, +1: VDIZ → ZGKA and HNAS → LQCT. So BJWP → FMYQ.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 132
After interchanging the signs: 121 – 1 + 6 × 16 ÷ 8 = 121 – 1 + 12 = 132.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Kesavanad Bharati vs. State of Kerala Case
In Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) the Supreme Court held that Parliament may amend the Constitution but not alter its basic structure.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Puducherry
In NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index: A Progress Review 2023 (data for 2019-21), Puducherry had the lowest share of multidimensionally poor people among the union territories.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Khanwa
Babur defeated Rana Sanga at Khanwa in 1527, a year after his victory at the First Battle of Panipat.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Pataliputra
Pushyamitra Sunga, who overthrew the last Maurya king, ruled from Pataliputra, the old Mauryan capital.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury
Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury, then the Congress MP for Baharampur in West Bengal and the party's leader in the Lok Sabha, was among the 2023 Sansad Ratna awardees. The other three were also honoured that year, but Kuldeep Rai Sharma was a Congress MP from the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Bidyut Baran Mahato (Jharkhand) and Sudhir Gupta (Madhya Pradesh) BJP MPs.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Sandhya Raju
Sandhya Raju won the National Film Award for Best Choreography at the 68th awards for the Telugu film 'Natyam'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Goa
Fugdi is a folk dance performed by women in Goa and the Konkan region.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Delhi gharana
Tanras Khan, a nineteenth-century khayal singer at the court of Bahadur Shah Zafar, is a leading figure of the Delhi gharana.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Jammu and Kashmir - Tamil Nadu
The North-South Corridor of the National Highways Development Project runs from Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir to Kanyakumari in Tamil Nadu.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Producing organic matter from inorganic substances
Autotrophs such as green plants make organic food from inorganic substances (carbon dioxide and water) using sunlight: they are the ecosystem's producers.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Estuaries
Estuaries, where rivers meet the sea, are rich in nutrients and shelter the young of many marine fish and shellfish, hence 'nurseries of the ocean'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Stupa
A stupa is a dome-shaped mound built over relics of the Buddha or other revered figures. A chaitya is a prayer hall and a vihara a monastery.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Amritlal Nagar
Amritlal Nagar's Hindi novel 'Amrit Aur Vish' won the Sahitya Akademi Award in 1967.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 183
The Census of India counts as a marginal worker anyone who worked for less than 183 days (six months) of the year; 183 days or more makes a main worker.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Iron industry
The Agarias of central India were iron smelters, who made iron in small clay furnaces.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Amit Shah
Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the Vibrant Villages Programme for border villages at Kibithoo, Arunachal Pradesh, in April 2023.

Q.17 · Answer (B) They do not generate much revenue in comparison to others.
Wealth tax and gift tax have never brought in much revenue, which is why they are called 'paper taxes'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Mumbai
The Kala Ghoda Arts Festival is held every year in Mumbai's Kala Ghoda art district.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Negative
An electron carries a negative charge; protons are positive and neutrons neutral.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Brahmaputra
The Subansiri joins the Brahmaputra from the north and the Dhansiri from the south, both in Assam.

Q.21 · Answer (D) India and Australia
The Border-Gavaskar Trophy, named after Allan Border and Sunil Gavaskar, is contested in Test cricket between India and Australia.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Sarkaria Commission
The Sarkaria Commission (set up in 1983) reviewed Centre-state relations and suggested ways to make the federal system work better. The Kothari Commission was on education; the Thakkar and Kapur Commissions inquired into the assassinations of Indira Gandhi and Mahatma Gandhi.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
Gopal Krishna Gokhale presided over the 1905 Banaras session of the Congress.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Vitamin K
Vitamin K is needed to make the blood's clotting factors, so a lack of it can cause excessive bleeding.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Squash
Anahat Singh is one of India's leading young squash players.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) hard
'Hard' is itself the adverb here: 'He works hard.' 'Hardly' and 'scarcely' mean almost not, which contradicts 'a hard worker'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) at arm’s length
The idiom is 'at arm's length': to keep something at a safe distance.

Q.3 · Answer (A) bury the hatchet
To 'bury the hatchet' is to end a quarrel and make peace.

Q.4 · Answer (A) paralel
The correct spelling is 'parallel'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Most numerous
SSC's key gives 'most numerous', with 'most' in its sense of 'very' (as in 'a most welcome change'), stressing how many attempts there were. 'Numerous attempts' alone is also correct English, so 'No substitution' is arguable too; 'more numerous' would need a comparison.

Q.7 · Answer (C) find; fined
'Find' (discover) and 'fined' (made to pay a penalty) sound alike: 'I could find the reason for being fined.'

Q.8 · Answer (B) Plaintiff
A plaintiff brings a case against another person, the defendant, in a court of law.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Anarchy
'Anarchy' is disorder due to the absence of government or authority. Dictatorship, oligarchy and monarchy are all forms of rule.

Q.10 · Answer (A) No improvement required
The present perfect 'has joined' suits a recent action that still matters, and 'to celebrate' gives its purpose: the sentence is already correct.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Unlikely
'Presumably' means probably, as one may reasonably suppose; its opposite is 'unlikely'. 'Certainly' only makes it stronger.

Q.14 · Answer (C) most updated
After 'the' the superlative fits: 'the most updated one'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) shocking
'Appalling' means shocking or dreadful.

Q.16 · Answer (C) farther
SSC's key gives 'farther', the comparative traditionally used for physical distance; 'than' rules out the superlatives 'farthest' and 'furthest'. 'Further' is also used for distance, especially in British English, so it is arguable too.

Q.18 · Answer (C) A myriad of possibilities unfolds when an artist embarks on a journey of creative experimentation.
SSC's key gives the sentence with the indefinite article throughout, as suits a general statement about any artist: 'A myriad of possibilities unfolds when an artist embarks on a journey of creative experimentation.' The versions with 'the' are not ungrammatical, but they presume a particular artist or journey already known to the reader.

Q.19 · Answer (B) He sings good
'Sings' needs an adverb: 'He sings well'. 'Good' is an adjective.

Q.20 · Answer (A) was not accept
The plural subject 'recommendations' takes 'were', and the passive needs the past participle: 'were not accepted'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) satisfaction
Reading gives 'mental satisfaction', in keeping with the passage's praise of it.

Q.22 · Answer (B) knowledge
Reading helps us 'acquire knowledge', the usual pairing.

Q.23 · Answer (B) expansion
Reading brings 'intellectual expansion': it broadens the mind, the opposite of 'stagnation'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) boredom
Reading 'takes away our boredom', in keeping with the passage's praise of it; taking away our time or vigour would make it a drawback.

Q.25 · Answer (A) comfort
Reading can bring 'comfort' in sorrowful times.

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